

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Boundaries	Hard

Question

For scientists to produce new iron nanoparticles of a specific size or strength, they must first be able to monitor reactions between oxygen and existing iron nanoparticles at a near-atomic level of detail. Fortunately, chemistry _____ and his colleagues at Temple University recently developed a new approach that does just that.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

- A. professor Yugang Sun
- B. professor Yugang Sun,
- C. professor, Yugang Sun,
- D. professor, Yugang Sun

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is the use of punctuation between titles and proper nouns. No punctuation is needed between the proper noun “Yugang Sun” and the title that describes Sun, “chemistry professor.” Furthermore, no punctuation is needed after “Sun” because “chemistry professor Yugang Sun and his colleagues at Temple University” functions as the coordinated subject of the sentence, and together Sun and colleagues performed the action of developing a new approach to producing iron nanoparticles.

Choice B is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the proper noun “Yugang Sun” and the coordinated noun phrase “and his colleagues at Temple University.” Choice C is incorrect because no punctuation is needed before or after the proper noun “Yugang Sun.” Setting off the professor’s name with commas suggests that it could be removed without affecting the coherence of the sentence, which isn’t the case. Choice D is incorrect because no punctuation is needed between the title “chemistry professor” and the proper noun “Yugang Sun.”